Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Paclitaxel weekly for 12 doses with trastuzumab every 3 weeks; continue trastuzumab to complete one year of HER2 treatment when appropriate. The team selects intravenous (IV) trastuzumab or locally approved subcutaneous trastuzumab; these are alternative formulations, not additional medicines.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy

Hair loss or thinning varies; ask about support.

2 Mouth

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

3 Breathing

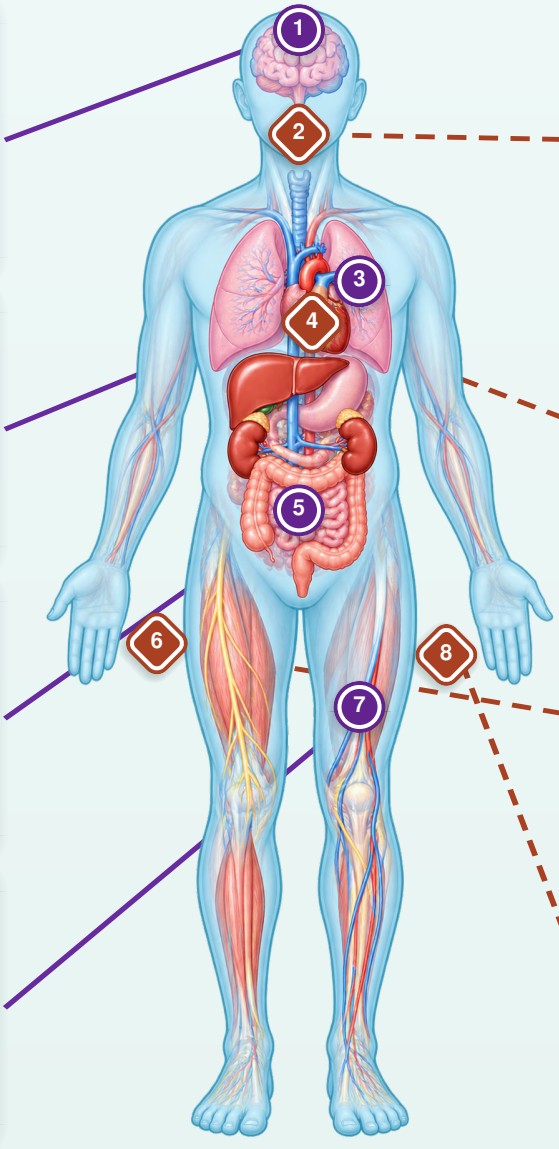
Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

4 Heart

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

New chest pain, fainting or severe breathlessness needs urgent assessment.



5 Bowel

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Report diarrhoea early, especially with poor intake or dizziness.

6 Nerves / joints

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Report numbness, tingling or pain affecting daily activity.

7 Blood / infection

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Fever, shivers, unusual bleeding or sudden illness: call promptly.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Report severe rash, blistering or yellow skin / eyes promptly.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Medicine-specific effects are highlighted; this is not a complete list. New or persistent symptoms still need review after treatment stops.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

NCCP 00815 · PRACTICAL SUPPORT

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Anti-sickness plan

Follow the prevention and rescue instructions prescribed for this schedule. Call if vomiting prevents drinking.

Infection and bleeding

Know the local urgent-contact number. Fever, shivering, sudden illness or unusual bleeding needs prompt advice even between visits.

Medicine review

Show the oncology pharmacist all prescribed, over-the-counter and herbal medicines. Ask before starting anything new.

Premedicines belong to the active phase

Paclitaxel reaction medicines and AC anti-sickness medicines have different purposes. They are not automatically continued during trastuzumab-only treatment.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00815/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.